

Farm Business

Science

May, 2026

Farm Business (A11428)

Short Title: Farm Business
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Science
Cluster Business
Author TWOODCOCK
Credits 5

Level: Intermediate

Description of Module / Aims

This module will enable the student to acquire an in-depth knowledge of farm business planning, as well as succession and inheritance issues. The module will enable students to interpret farm accounts and outline how financial performance can be improved.

Programmes

AGRI -0093	BSc (Hons) in Agricultural Science (WD_SAGRI_B)	3 / 5 / M
AGRI -0093	BSc in Agriculture (WD_SAGUL_D)	3 / 6 / M

Indicative Content

- Farm accounts analysis and evaluation
- Farm business planning
- Farmer succession and inheritance plans

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Interpret final accounts for a farm business.
2. Use financial ratios to monitor and control the financial strengths of the farm business.
3. Complete a farm business plan.
4. Complete a farm succession plan.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Practical instruction.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	50%	1, 2,
Continuous Assessment	50%	
<i>Assignment</i>	30%	3
<i>Assignment</i>	20%	4

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Inadequate understanding of the fundamentals of farm business and insufficient competence in their use.

40%-49%: Ability to show a basic knowledge. Basic level of knowledge of chosen topic.

50%-59%: As well as the above, the student will be able to demonstrate an understanding of some of the complexities of farm business management competency in their use.

60%-69%: In addition to the above, the student will demonstrate a more detailed knowledge of farm business and a high level of competence in the area use. Display a high level of knowledge of chosen research topic, supplemented by an ability to present this knowledge to a high technical standard.

70%-100%: All of the above to an excellent level. The above advanced knowledge of the topic will be supported by superior skills.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	24	
Practical	24	
Independent Learning	87	

Essential Material

- Connolly, K. _Finance Act 2014, Agri Tax Measures_. Ireland: Teagasc, 2015.
- Keenan, D. _Whole Farm Planning_. Ireland: Teagasc, 2009.
- McDonnell, J., M. Kirk, K. Connolly, C. Finlay and T. Curran. _A Guide to Transferring the Family Farm_. Ireland: Teagasc, 2015.
- O'Sullivan, M. _The Farmers Handbook_. Ireland: Agriculture Advisory Alliance, 2016.

Supplementary Material

- Nuthall, P.L. _Farm Business Management, The Human Factor_. New Zealand: CABI, 2010.
- Turner, J. _Applied Farm Management_. 3rd. United States: Blackwell Science, 2012.